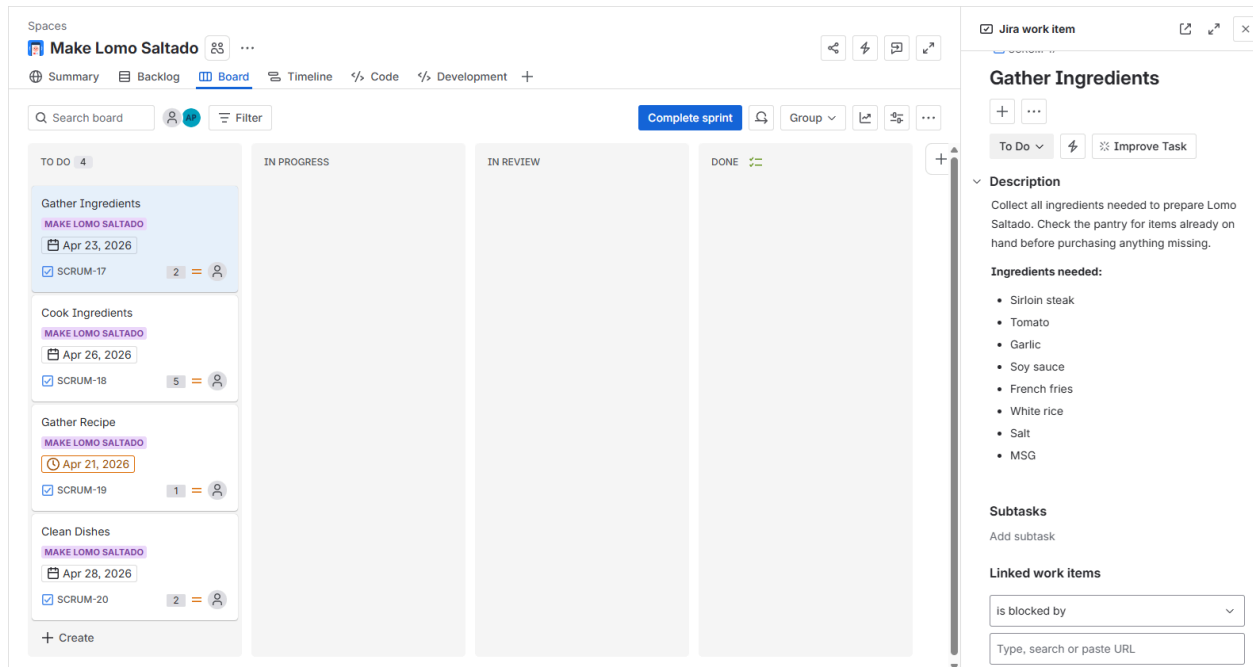


4.2 Exercise: Jira First Look



1. Useful Features

The feature I found most valuable was the Board view with its Kanban-style layout. I personally enjoy Kanban boards as a way to visualize work in progress, and Jira's implementation of it felt intuitive once I understood how epics and stories related to each other. Being able to see all four tasks (Gather Recipe, Gather Ingredients, Cook Lomo Saltado, and Clean Dishes) laid out in columns made it easy to understand the overall state of the project at a glance. I can see this being especially useful on a real software team tracking many tasks at once.

2. Surprises or Friction

The biggest source of confusion for me was understanding how the Epic, Board, and Timeline views relate to each other. At first I didn't realize that the project title itself functioned as the Epic. I expected it to be a separate card on the board like the stories were. I also found that the Board and Timeline didn't sync as smoothly as I expected. For example, when I added due dates to tasks on the Board, they didn't automatically reflect correctly on the Timeline. I'm not sure if I missed a step or misconfigured something, but it felt like the views operated somewhat independently of each other rather than as one unified system.

3. Connection to Agile

The experience connected clearly to the agile concepts from Weeks 1 and 2. The sprint I set up (April 21 through April 28) mirrors the time-boxed iteration structure from Scrum. The Epic representing the overall goal of "Make Lomo Saltado" and the Stories breaking it down into smaller deliverables directly reflects the agile backlog hierarchy. Story point estimates on each task illustrated how teams estimate relative effort rather than time for a task.